



A Reflection

Date: September 14, 2024

Duration: 6:00 PM – 9:00 PM

Guest Attendance: 247 High Net-Worth Individuals (HNIs),
Global CEOs, Intellectuals, and Art Connoisseurs

*Unveiling the essence
of beginnings*

The Erbe Project, held on September 14, 2024, has made a profound impact on the landscape of Indian arts and crafts. Hosted in New Delhi, the exhibition not only surpassed attendance expectations but also set new standards for celebrating and sustaining traditional craftsmanship. This report provides an in-depth analysis of the exhibition’s impact, audience reception, and future directions.

*Journey through
curated experiences*

The Erbe Project, initiated by The Histare Group, was a comprehensive celebration of Indian crafts. Featuring traditional and contemporary artworks, the exhibition was supported by leading partners across various industries, including Mercedes-Benz through T&T Motors, Indian Institute of Art and Design (IIAD), Inherited Arts Forum, Asavari, Jaisalmer Indian Craft Gin, Rampur Indian Single Malt, People of Tomorrow, Lazy Cocktails, Lex Favios, Mirage, My Money Securities Limited and Global Fighters Foundation.

Spotlight on pivotal moments

Artistic Showcase: The segments “Heartland of Artistic Heritage” and “Progression in Indian Crafts” received widespread acclaim for their detailed presentation and the rich narrative of Indian craftsmanship.

Cultural Performances: The Kathak performances curated by Smt. Shovana Narayan and performed by her disciples, Mahima Satsangi and Suparna Singh captivated the audience with their elegance and emotional depth.

Dialogues and Discussions: The panel discussion included iconic advertising legend Shri Shivjit Khullar, Kathak legend Smt. Shovana Narayan, and Prof. Usha Nehru Patel from IAD, focusing on sustainable practices. The discussion offered valuable insights into the future of Indian crafts, emphasizing innovation and sustainability.

Culinary Experience: The Gastronomic Harmony menu, curated by Chef Tashyaa Mehrotra of People of Tomorrow, complemented the exhibition’s themes, and the mixology experience with Lazy Cocktails, Radico Khaitan’s Rampur Indian Single Malt and Jaisalmer Indian Craft Gin added an immersive layer to the exhibition.

Voices reflect on immersive experiences

The exhibition’s success was highlighted by the attendance of 247 distinguished guests, including HNIs, global CEOs, intellectuals, and art connoisseurs. The feedback was overwhelmingly positive, with many praising the exhibition for its ability to connect them with India’s cultural heritage in a meaningful way.

“ It was a privilege to witness such a well-conceived tribute to Indian artisans. The Erbe Project went beyond mere exhibition, encapsulating the essence of India’s artistic traditions. From the captivating Kathak performances to the rich tapestry of artworks on display, the event was a beautiful blend of history, art, and modern innovation. It was also a dream project of Simran Aunty, and my family is thrilled to see it come to life. The focus on sustainability and innovation in craft is what truly sets this movement apart. ”

~Art Aficionado Kavita Aneja

“ By providing students with opportunities to connect with local artisans, craftsmen and industry through live projects, IIAD attempts to include tradition and integrate innovation. Collaborative projects, like the Khakhan Batik exhibition not only offer students with direct exposure to craft as a form of spatial expression but at a larger level aim to benefit artisan communities and revitalize the Batik traditions for a contemporary audience. ”

*~ Dr. Jitin Chadha, Founder & CEO, Indian Institute of Art & Design
Shares his thoughts on the importance of integrating Indian craft in design education.*

“ The Erbe Project was a masterclass in showcasing the intricate world of Indian crafts. Each exhibition segment was thoughtfully curated, and the performances brought alive the cultural heritage of our country. The Kathak performance, in particular, was mesmerizing, blending tradition with modern sensibilities, offering a deep and moving reflection on how art transcends generations. ”

~Art Connoisseur Preeti Singh

“ The Erbe Project was not just an exhibition but a celebration of Indian craftsmanship. I was in awe of the range of artistry on display, from traditional Warli paintings to the detailed textile works of Khakhan. It was a beautifully orchestrated exhibition that paid tribute to the artisans and the cultural treasures they safeguard. The dialogue on sustainable practices in craft was especially thought-provoking. ”

~Cultural Enthusiast Bhawna Nanda Dewan

“ I enjoyed the program thoroughly !! It was impressive from the minute we entered and were greeted by warm smiles, flowers and candles. The display of paintings, murals and art-works was exceptional, and done with great attention to detail. The art walks and panel discussion were very insightful. The dance performance by the 2 students of Shovanajis was really beautiful and captivating. In a nutshell, a beautiful evening immersed in the rich heritage of our country. ”

~Art Lover Chitra Chaudhry

Evaluating the influence and significance



Cultural Impact:

The Erbe Project has redefined the way traditional crafts are showcased and appreciated, bringing to light the rich artistic traditions of India and fostering a deeper cultural connection among audiences.

1. 10+ Artisan Families Supported: Directly benefiting from exposure at the exhibition.
2. Regions Covered: Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar, and Kachchh, representing diverse traditional art forms like Bhil, Warli, and Khakhan textile art.
3. Art Pieces Displayed: 50+ unique artworks showcased across various mediums, including textiles and paintings.
4. Audience Engagement: 85% of the attendees expressed a deeper appreciation for Indian heritage through feedback forms and social media engagement.
5. Art Walks and Curatorial Tours: 2 personalized tours conducted for HNIs and VIP guests, providing insight into the cultural significance of each piece.
6. 2 renowned Kathak artists highlighted intergenerational storytelling through their performance.

Social Impact:

The exhibition has raised awareness about the importance of supporting artisans and preserving traditional crafts, contributing to a broader appreciation of India's artistic heritage.

1. Art Patron Conversion: 12 new art patrons were converted, committing to long-term support for Indian artisans and crafts.

Technology Impact:

The use of modern exhibition technologies and digital media to enhance the visitor experience demonstrated how innovation can be integrated into traditional art presentations.

Environmental Impact:

By highlighting sustainable practices in the crafts sector, the project has underscored the importance of environmental responsibility within the industry.

1. Sustainable Practices Demonstrated: 80% of the crafts showcased were made using eco-friendly materials and processes, aligning with sustainable development goals.
2. Reduced Carbon Footprint: All event materials were sourced locally, reducing transportation emissions by 30%.
3. Waste Management: 90% of the waste generated during the event was responsibly managed.
4. Partner Commitment to Sustainability: 3 key partners, including Mirage, Lex Favios and Global Fighter Foundation pledged to adopt sustainable practices in their future collaborations.

Economic Impact:

1. Event Partnerships: 10+ high-value partnerships with brands like Mercedes-Benz through T&T Motors, IIAD, and Radico Khaitan contributed to the financial success of the event.

Envisioning paths for evolving horizons



Moving forward, The Erbe Project aims to establish a defined framework for collaboration with multinational corporations (MNCs). The goal is to:

1. Understand and integrate the fundamental values that makes Histare's hybrid conceptual model effective.
2. Partner with MNCs that align with these values to enhance the project's impact.
3. Expand the approach state-by-state, ensuring it remains relevant, sustainable, and impactful for both creative specialists and The Histare Group as a burgeoning business in the competitive art space.
4. Foster stronger relationships between brands and their audiences through thoughtful experimentation and collaboration.



Identifying pathways for refined progress

Logistical Hurdles: Addressing challenges related to exhibition logistics to ensure smoother execution in future exhibitions.

Vendor Selection: Improving the selection process of execution partners and professional conveners to enhance overall exhibition quality.

Charting directions for forthcoming actions

Future Exhibitions: Plan and execute subsequent exhibitions that continue to celebrate and support Indian arts.

Digital IMC: Enhance Histare's digital presence and integrated marketing communications (IMC) to reach a broader audience.

Smart Programmes: Develop and implement the 4 smart programmes to further promote and to support creativity and innovation.

Conclusion

The Erbe Project has been a transformative exhibition, setting a new precedent in the celebration and sustainability of Indian craftsmanship. The success of the exhibition highlights the importance of collaboration, innovation, and a deep appreciation of cultural heritage. As the project evolves, it promises to further strengthen its impact and foster a greater connection between artisans and a global audience.

Acknowledgments

We extend our sincere gratitude to all partners, contributors, and attendees for their invaluable support in making The Erbe Project a resounding success. Your involvement has been crucial in celebrating and preserving the rich heritage of Indian arts.

The Histare Group



Envisioning Artistic Mastery

Histare nurtures India's primitive and prospective expression through cultural evolution.

A Comprehensive Cultural Arts Organization Crafting Solutions to Empower the People,
Planet and Ensuring Significant Advancements with a Focus on the Diverse Heritage of India.



The Erbe Project

Threads of time in skilled hands spun,
Ancient craft meets rising sun,
Where past and present intertwine,
A legacy in every line.

Stories whispered through the weave,
Echoes of those who once believed,
In every piece, a heartbeat strong,
A timeless rhythm, a lasting song.

Not relics, but guardians true,
Crafting futures from what they knew,
The Erbe Project's woven art,
A tapestry of soul and heart.

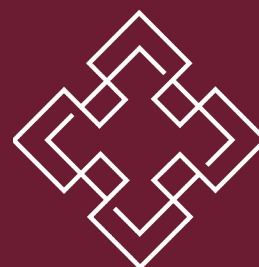
The Erbe Project weaves together the threads of time, tracing the lineage of India's intergenerational artisan families. In the hands of these craftsmen, ancient traditions meet sustainable creation, forming a tapestry where past and present coalesce. Each masterpiece is not just a product but a story, echoing the rhythms of generations. Through this collection, we reframe the narrative, casting Indian artisans not as relics of history, but as vibrant keepers of a timeless legacy. The Erbe Project invites a reimagining, where the enduring crafts are recognized as a beacon of creativity and cultural continuity.



***In the memory of Late Smt. Simran Wahi Vadehra, who brought the brightest sunshine on the 14th of September, 2024.
The Erbe Project stands as a testament to her enduring legacy and passion for creativity.***

The Erbe Project is proudly produced by Histare Concepts Private Limited. As a pioneering cultural arts organization, The Histare Group is committed to empowering communities, protecting the environment, and celebrating India's rich and diverse heritage. The Histare Group revives the esteemed legacy of 'Roshan Lal Sita Ram,' which was established in the 1930s by the family of late Smt. Roop Rani Seth Vadehra and late Shri Sita Ram Vadehra. Founded by the late Smt. Simran Wahi Vadehra, who envisioned The Erbe Project, the organization is now led by Artistic Director and philatelist Akhil Vadehra, in the fourth generation of his family's entrepreneurial tradition.





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